READING AND PERFORMANCE EDITION

Babylon Isaiah and Revelation

Dramatic cycle in seven scenes

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Pattern Monkey

From Babylon Whore and BLETTERABYLON

Working texts dated 16–17 October 2026
Reading edition 17 October 2026

A guilty city questions the justice of her judgment.
The voices that accuse her must answer in turn.

The voices and the hearing

An imagined encounter between Babylon and two personified biblical books. The speeches preserve the working texts' arguments; Isaiah and Revelation are dramatic voices, not transcriptions of a historical conversation or new scriptural revelation.

BABYLON

The accused city becomes a cross-examiner. Exacting, self-implicated, unwilling to let her own guilt end the inquiry. She concedes injuries she caused and tests whether an answer can survive the perspective of the person who suffers.

ISAIAH

A prophetic accuser with the old man's burden in view. Severe and concrete. He distinguishes the conqueror's usefulness from the conqueror's innocence, then gives the survivor a promise of release.

REVELATION

A witness to a vision who defends its judgments. Ceremonial in the opening, increasingly precise under questioning. He keeps the dead in the hearing and acknowledges explanations the text does not supply.

Performance convention

Three readers are sufficient. The staging assumes one continuous hearing rather than a reconstruction of ancient events. Isaiah remains a silent witness after Scene II; no additional speech is assigned to him. An optional reader may announce scene titles.

Line endings guide breath; stanza spaces permit thought. A break need not become a full stop. Speaker names are silent cues. Bracketed italic directions and scene titles are additions for this edition. Small raised numbers lead to references at the back and are not spoken. Only passages explicitly labeled "Scriptural wording" in the notes are direct biblical quotations.

Sequence of scenes

I The charges 4

Cruelty, commerce, sorcery, and the people inside the city.

II The axe and the wound 8

Divine purpose and the conqueror’s culpability.

III The purpose and the fire 11

The judgment of Babylon and the guilt of her destroyers.

IV The captive 16

Fear, worship, endurance, and unequal blame.

V The tears 19

The promise of healing and the justification of suffering.

VI The returned life 22

The clean-slate proposal meets continuing responsibility.

VII Whose life 25

Consent, accountability, and the unresolved hearing.

After the cycle

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SCENE I

The charges

[Three voices at the same table. The hearing has already begun. Babylon listens through the charges.]

ISAIAH

Babylon—

you have answered the dust.

Now answer the old man
bent beneath your yoke.

I had already named him.

The Lord says he delivered his people
into your hands.
You met their defeat
with merciless rule.

Then you imagined
your throne had no last day.

You ask me to remember
the people inside your walls.

Remember the people
you brought through them.

And yes—
I announced your exposure.
My oracle makes your humiliation
part of the judgment.

You heard its violence correctly.
I will not give you a gentler speech
and pretend it was the one I spoke.

But hear the charge beneath your boasting:

you believed yourself unobserved.

Your learning helped persuade you
that consequences belonged
to other people.

Now summon your specialists.

Let the readers of the heavens
bring their forecasts.
Let your practiced enchantments
meet the disaster you never expected.

They have advised you for years.

Let them save you.

Your confidence has reached
the hour
when it must produce
what it promised.[1]

REVELATION

Babylon—

you ask whether I noticed
the merchants.

I wrote down their inventory.

You ask whether I noticed
the people among the goods.

I put them there
where the reader must encounter them.

You ask us to listen carefully
to the mourning.

Listen.

The buyers have disappeared.
That is why the sellers weep.

The kings enjoyed your luxury.
The traders accumulated fortunes.

Their distance from your burning
does not erase
their closeness to your table.

You have named your accomplices.

They were already in the vision.[2]

And your robe—

yes, the image is cruel.

The beast that carries you
will turn against you.
The kings will strip you,
consume your flesh,
and burn what remains.

I place even their purpose
within the fulfillment of God's words.

That is the terror
of the vision I recorded.

But those kings also march
against the Lamb.

Their violence against you
does not make them
the final victors.

You tell me power changes hands.

I tell you the hands
are answerable
to someone they cannot overthrow.[3]

Now your *pharmakeia*.

You have given it
a persuasive speech
about silk and kings.

My sentence names sorcery
and the deception of nations.

Your merchants stand beside that accusation.

I leave no recipe.
I do not explain the mechanism.

The word carries its charge
into a city of wealth and power.

How those belong together
is a question my readers must confront.[4]

Then read the next line.

Blood.

Prophets.
Holy people.
The slaughtered of the earth.

Before the judgment falls,
a voice calls God's people
to leave you.

There are people within your walls
whom the voice addresses
as its own.

They must refuse participation
in what you have done.

You ask for the dead
to enter the hearing.

Their blood
is already evidence.

You ask who will profit
from the ruins.

My vision ends your commerce,
your music,
your lamplight.

The judgment does not offer
another buyer
your throne.[5]

[A pause. Babylon turns first to Isaiah.]

SCENE II

The axe and the wound

[Babylon speaks without leaving the place of the accused.]

BABYLON

Isaiah—
you say God placed his people
in my hands.
Then you accuse those hands
of showing no mercy.
I understand the distinction.
Power over the defeated
did not require me
to make the old man's burden heavier.
I cannot point toward heaven
and make my cruelty disappear.
But keep that distinction before us.
We will need it
when the next empire arrives.[6]

Elsewhere in your book,
you speak of Assyria.
God sends him
to seize and plunder,
to trample a people underfoot.
Assyria has ambitions of his own.
He wants more destruction.
He admires his strength.
He mistakes the reach of his arm
for proof that history belongs to him.
And when God's work is finished,
you announce punishment
for the king's arrogance.
You compare him to an axe
boasting against the one who swings it.
Very well.

You have distinguished
the conqueror's intention
from the purpose that uses him.

Now stand beside
the person beneath the axe.

Explain what that distinction
does for the wound.[7]

ISAIAH

Babylon—

you ask what the distinction
does for the wound.

It does not make the wound
imaginary.

But it denies the conqueror
the defense you are testing:

If God used my victory,
everything I did was justified.

Look again at Assyria.

God sends him against a people.
The king imagines nations
disappearing beneath his power.

God's purpose and the king's ambition
occupy the same history.

They remain distinguishable.

The king boasts that his own strength
has gathered the world.

And the judgment reaches him
after the work
he served without understanding.

His usefulness
does not acquit his pride.[8]

You received a defeated people.

You made their weakness
an occasion for merciless rule.

That is the charge against you.

The sentence saying
God delivered them into your hands
stands beside the sentence
condemning what you did.

Neither cancels the other.[9]

You want an answer
for the person beneath the axe.

Hear what I promise the survivor:

the power striking you
will lose its hold.

The burden will leave your shoulder.
The yoke will leave your neck.

Assyria's place in God's purpose
gives Assyria
no permanent claim upon you.[10]

[Isaiah remains at the table. Babylon turns to Revelation.]

SCENE III

The purpose and the fire

[The hearing turns from Babylon's violence to the violence used against her.]

BABYLON

And you, Revelation—

read your sentences slowly.

The beast and the kings
will turn their hatred upon me.

They will strip me,
devour me,
burn me.

Then comes your explanation:

God has placed it in their hearts
to carry out his purpose,
agreeing to surrender their kingdom
to the beast
until God's words are fulfilled.

I hear the hatred.

I hear the purpose.

Your account places them
beside one another.

You have already told me
these kings will fight the Lamb.

So they remain his enemies
while their agreement
serves the fulfillment of his words.

I understand that much.

But you have condemned
what power did through me.

Now power tears through me,
and the story gives its violence
a place within divine judgment.

Tell me how to distinguish
the justice of that purpose
from the cruelty
of its instruments.

Tell me what judgment requires
of the hands
while they are doing the work.[11]

Yes.

I have read ahead.

The beast does not inherit heaven.

He and the false prophet
are thrown into the fire.
The gathered armies
are struck down.

You have written an ending
for my destroyers too.

I will not pretend
you have crowned them righteous.

But their eventual punishment
leaves my question standing:

how does their guilt
live inside the purpose
their actions fulfill?[12]

And I hear heaven's answer.

My corruption is judged.
The blood of God's servants
is avenged.

Heaven declares the judgment just
and sings
while my smoke rises.

I understand why the murdered
would want an answer.

I understand why those
who survived my rule
would greet its ending with relief.

Their testimony belongs here.

So does this question:

what makes vengeance just?

You have named the judge.
You have named my crimes.
You have announced the verdict.

I am asking about the fire
between them.[13]

Keep the record of what I did.

Keep the names
of the people I harmed.

My accusation does not erase theirs.

But leave room in the hearing
for someone guilty
to ask a question
the innocent may also need answered.

When you distinguish
the hand that wounds
from the purpose that employs it—

follow that distinction
all the way down.

To the body.

To the person
who must endure
the fulfillment.

REVELATION

Babylon—

you have read the conjunction correctly.

I connect the kings' agreement
with the fulfillment of God's words.

I do not describe God
as merely watching
an accident he could not govern.

But follow those kings
through the vision.

They surrender their authority
to the beast.

They turn against you.

They also make war
against the Lamb.

Serving the fulfillment of God's words
has not made them
faithful to God.

Their allegiance remains
with the power
the Lamb defeats.[14]

You ask how their guilt
can remain inside that purpose.

My vision holds both claims:

their power is subject to God,
and their rebellion
remains rebellion.

I never grant them
the final judgment seat.

The beast is captured.
The armies gathered against the rider
are overcome.

And I call the rider's judgment
and warfare righteous.

That is the distinction
my vision asserts.

Its justice rests upon
who God is
and what his judgment answers.[15]

You ask about the body.

Before I showed you burning,
I showed the murdered
beneath the altar.

They were asking
how long judgment would wait.

The demand for an answer
was already coming
from those who had endured
the violence.

I recorded their impatience.

I also recorded
the terrible waiting
that followed it.[16]

When heaven celebrates your fall,
it names the blood of God's servants
as the wrong being answered.

Your loss of power
belongs to their vindication.

That is why heaven calls
the judgment just.[17]

BABYLON

As for the kings
who turn against me—

I understand that their hatred
and God's purpose
need not be the same intention.

Your vision can distinguish them.

But follow every distinction
to the person it touches:

the purpose,
the instrument,
the act,
the wound.

Their place in the fulfillment
does not acquit their conduct.

Their guilt does not explain
why employing their conduct
was just.

You have distinguished the hands.
Now answer for the work
each hand performs.[18]

[No answer is added. Let the question remain before the next scene.]

SCENE IV

The captive

[The scale narrows. Babylon places two imagined kneeling people before the hearing.]

BABYLON

Revelation—

bring the whole vision.

The Lamb who was slain.
The people redeemed from the nations.
The suffering announced
in that same Lamb's presence.

I will consider them together.
But considering everything
cannot mean deciding beforehand
that everything must acquit him.[19]

Begin with the captive.

Your beast threatens death.
Its mark controls buying and selling.
You expressly include the enslaved
within its reach.

One person kneels
because the beast promises advancement.

Another kneels
because the beast has made refusal
a road toward death.

The gesture may look alike.
The freedom behind it does not.

Your own account
has supplied the difference.
Keep it in the account.[20]

If both fall under your warning,
show me what makes each answerable.

I will not borrow the persecutor's guilt
to complete the captive's sentence.

Nor will I declare
that every frightened act is innocent.

I am asking what the fear changes.

Perhaps the act remains forbidden.
Perhaps some responsibility remains.
Neither answer yet establishes
the punishment you announce.

A command can be firm
while those who break beneath it
bear unequal blame.

A sentence can be consistently applied
and still require a defense.[21]

You say Christ searches hearts.

Then he can know
who desired the beast's victory
and who wanted another morning.

I do not accuse him
of being unable to see the difference.

I ask what difference
his judgment makes of it.

Knowledge of the wound
and the weight assigned to it
are separate matters.

Opening every book
does not explain
how the court reads terror.[22]

REVELATION

Your two kneeling people
have the same outward outline.

That outline cannot tell us
everything about either life.

Here we agree.

But my account of judgment
includes more than the outline.

Christ searches hearts and minds.
He repays people according to their deeds.

That is my claim
that the person remains visible
within the judgment.[23]

You rightly ask
what weight the terror receives.

I do not give you
the captive's hearing.

I cannot turn the promise
of inward knowledge
into a disclosed account
of every sentence.

But neither will I invent
the captive's motives
to make my warning easier to defend.

My demand remains severe.

The beast threatens life.
I require fidelity
even when fidelity costs life.

To Smyrna,
Christ promises life beyond death
to those who remain faithful.

That is why the threat
does not settle
what they ought to do.

The power that can kill them
does not thereby receive
their rightful worship.[24]

You ask a further question:
what does someone deserve
when fear defeats that fidelity?

The command alone
does not measure that blame.

My warning announces punishment
and calls for endurance.
It does not separately explain
how every degree of coercion
affects the sentence.

Your question reaches
an explanation I have not supplied.

It does not require me
to abandon the obligation
whose failure you are examining.[25]

[A full silence after "examining." The promise comes next.]

SCENE V

The tears

[Revelation speaks the promise quietly. Babylon listens before answering.]

REVELATION

But follow the vision
beyond the battlefield.

God comes to dwell
among the people.

Tears are wiped away.
Death loses its place.
Grief and pain
belong to the world passing away.

You asked me
to follow the purpose
down to the person.

That is where
my promise finally arrives:

at the face
from which God
removes the tears.[26]

BABYLON

Now show me the hand
that wipes away tears.

I want that promise
to reach the people I harmed.

Let grief loosen its hold.
Let the next funeral
never become necessary.

But keep the road
beside its destination.

A person who arrives unharmed
and a person who arrives healed
have not traveled the same history.

Restoration can change
what the wound becomes.
It cannot, by itself, establish
that inflicting it was right.

I cannot prove
that a painless road was possible
merely by imagining one.

Neither can you establish
that this road was necessary
merely by showing me its end.

And necessity, if you establish it,
still leaves us asking
what means may rightly be used.

Your promise gives us hope.
Let the justification
answer for the suffering.[27]

And your ending has a boundary.

The chapter that promises
an end to pain
also names the second death.

I will not gather everyone
into an embrace
your account does not give everyone.

That is why
the judgment still needs examining.

The joy of those welcomed
cannot supply the missing culpability
of someone condemned.[28]

REVELATION

Now the tears.

I accept your distinction
between a wound healed
and a wound rightly inflicted.

My own vision needs it.

The witnesses killed for their testimony
are raised and vindicated.

Their restoration does not make
their murder righteous.

Indeed, heaven's celebration
names bloodshed as a wrong
for which judgment has come.[29]

So I need not argue:
the ending is good,
therefore every act along the way was good.

I distinguish
the violence I condemn
from the punishment I affirm.

You may dispute that distinction's application.
But let us examine
the grounds I actually give.

When the waters become blood,
the angel connects that punishment
with the blood of saints and prophets
its recipients shed.

The claim is repayment
for culpable injury.

You may question the measure.
You may question the means.

But the proposed justification
concerns the wrongdoing being answered,
not merely the happiness
that follows afterward.[30]

And that argument
cannot simply be transferred
from a killer
to your frightened captive.

Each claim
must carry its own grounds.

[Keep the silence. The next question concerns those who return.]

SCENE VI

The returned life

[Babylon lays her proposed rule beside Revelation's account of judgment.]

BABYLON

Now bring the dead.

The sea relinquishes them.
Death and Hades relinquish them.
The books are opened.

I read you correctly:
you present people
answering for their own deeds.

I will not invent strangers
and accuse your court
of giving them somebody else's crimes.

But here I bring
a rule that challenges yours:

a returned life begins
without an automatic inheritance
of guilt, punishment, or compulsory obligation.

That is the clean slate I defend.
I will not pretend
it is a promise
hidden in your chapter.

Your account carries responsibility
across death.

My rule demands release
across that return.

That is our disagreement.
Let us face it plainly.[31]

Keep the history.

A clean slate
must not make my victims disappear.

What I did remains
something I did.
Their testimony remains theirs.

But preserving testimony
and claiming a returned life
as payment
are different acts.

If I freely undertake repair,
let that present commitment matter.

If I threaten someone now,
answer that present danger.

But explain what authorizes
the suffering imposed
for the life that ended.

You may answer:
these are the same people,
so responsibility continues.

I understand the claim.
Continued identity
does not settle our disagreement
about continued punishment.

And I know
that I would benefit
from the rule I propose.

Examine that interest.
Keep my crimes before us.

Then examine the rule.

Someone guilty
can still ask a question
whose answer matters
to the innocent.

REVELATION

Now your clean slate.

You have stated it honestly
as a rule you bring
to challenge mine.

Then hear my disagreement.

A change in a person's condition
does not, by itself,
decide what becomes
of responsibility.

The geometry of return
cannot establish an amnesty.

Neither can continued identity
establish every punishment.

We still need the moral rule
connecting the person,
the deed,
and what may rightly follow.

In my vision,
death does not close the account.

The dead stand before the throne.
Their deeds enter judgment.

And the faithful dead
are also accompanied by their works.

I carry a person's history
across death
in both promise and judgment.[32]

You preserve the history
but would release
the returned person's punitive liability.

I understand the difference.

You have not erased the record.
You have changed
what the record may authorize.

That change requires a defense
just as my continuing judgment does.

Calling the life returned
does not choose between our rules.

[The rule has been stated. Its claim over a life remains in dispute.]

SCENE VII

Whose life

[All three remain present. The last exchange is between Babylon and Revelation.]

BABYLON

You ask me to trust the Lamb.

His redemption gives me
a reason to listen.

The disputed punishment
gives me a reason
to keep asking.

Let both remain visible.

Do not make gratitude
a condition of being heard.
Do not make survival
proof of willing allegiance.
Do not make healing
the permission suffering needed.

And when you call
a person back to life—

tell me what makes
that life theirs.

REVELATION

Babylon—

then let us preserve
the distinctions we have found.

The captive's fear.
The persecutor's intention.
The wound.
The healing.
The person who returns.

And let us distinguish
the facts we remember
from the rules by which
we judge them.

[A breath.]

You ask what makes
that life theirs.

I answer that being answerable
for an injury
need not mean being owned
by the person injured.

A claim that wrongdoing
deserves judgment
is different from a claim
to possess the wrongdoer.

You may dispute
whether my punishment
honors that distinction.

But rejecting ownership
does not alone establish
that accountability must depend
on the wrongdoer's present consent.

My court does not make
that consent its condition.

I place the great and the small
before the same throne
and bring their deeds
into the hearing.[33]

You can reject that authority.
You can challenge its sentence.

Our disagreement then concerns
what justice may require
without a person's agreement.

It cannot be settled
by the word "return."

And I hear the harder question
beneath your clean slate:

why restore someone
to a life in which punishment
remains possible?

My answer is that death
must not determine
which deeds remain answerable.

You would allow remembrance
while ending the old punitive claim.

I would preserve answerability
beyond the grave.

Neither position becomes just
merely because it is consistent.

You ask me
to defend the judgment I retain.

I ask you
to defend the release you require.

Keep your challenge
beside my promise.

The healed wound
does not acquit its inflictor.

The captive's outward act
does not disclose the whole person.

The opened books
do not themselves explain
every measure of punishment.

But resurrection
does not, by itself,
command the end of accountability.

You have shown me
where my reasons must answer.

You have not made
your own rule
a consequence of the geometry.

I bring the dead
out of the keeping of Death.

I do not place their deeds
beyond the reach
of judgment.

[Revelation closes the speech. No one closes the hearing. Hold, then darkness.]

Editorial record

This edition changes sequence and presentation, not the wording of the speeches. All 330 substantive speech paragraphs from the two inspected sources appear once in the cycle. Original stanza boundaries, internal line breaks, punctuation, and emphasis are retained. Source citation suffixes have been moved into the numbered register; paragraph-ending line feeds become paragraph boundaries. Standalone dash dividers become typographic pauses or scene boundaries.

Speaker labels have been regularized and repeated where a moved block needs identification. Babylon's unlabelled speech in the first source is assigned to Babylon from its address to Isaiah and Revelation and its first-person admissions. Scene headings, bracketed directions, cast descriptions, navigation, and this apparatus are editorial additions. No new dramatic speech has been written.

Source witnesses

A Babylon Whore

Created 2026-10-16 14:22:00.676 UTC; last modified 2026-10-16 21:52:36.600 UTC.

B BLETTERABYLON:

Created 2026-10-17 01:21:00.366 UTC; last modified 2026-10-17 01:23:13.833 UTC.

The labels 16–17 October follow the source chronology in UTC. Source B's 01:23 UTC modification occurred on the evening of 16 October in America/Moncton. The originals were read without edits. Paragraph locators below count each Google Docs paragraph, including speaker labels, standalone dividers, framing, and the final empty paragraph: A has 196; B has 177. B therefore has 176 nonempty paragraphs. The full extracted strings contain 10,072 and 10,590 characters respectively, including paragraph terminators and internal line-break characters. These are extraction counts, not spoken-word counts.

Sequence and relocation map

Each range is inclusive. Original dividers inside a range remain pauses. Labels and attached reference material are handled as described above.

I The charges. A4–21 (Isaiah) → A25–64 (Revelation)

II The axe and the wound. A68–86 (Babylon) → A134–155 (Isaiah)

III The purpose and the fire. A88–132 (Babylon) → A158–185 (Revelation) → B45–52 (Babylon)

IV The captive. B2–26 (Babylon) → B92–112 (Revelation)

V The tears. A187–192 (Revelation) → B28–43 (Babylon) → B114–128 (Revelation)

VI The returned life. B54–77 (Babylon) → B130–146 (Revelation)

VII Whose life. B79–85 (Babylon) → B87–90 (Revelation) → B148–176 (Revelation)

Why the sequence changes

Scene I retains the first source's opening accusations. It begins in the middle of an existing dispute: "you have answered the dust" and the references to earlier arguments about merchants, robes, and silk point to material outside the two supplied pieces. The edition preserves those cues and does not invent the missing prior speeches.

Scene II brings Isaiah's later answer immediately after Babylon's question about Assyria. Scene III joins Babylon's challenge about her destroyers to Revelation's answer, then moves B45–52 forward as a short sharpening reprise. Its distinction between an instrument's guilt and the justice of employing it is the hinge into the captive's case.

Scene IV takes B2–26 with B92–112 so the captive's fear and the response about fidelity remain in one hearing. Scene V moves the first source's final promise of wiped-away tears beside the second source's challenge to restoration as justification. This is a change of dramatic order, not a claim about the canonical sequence of Revelation's visions.

Scene VI places the clean-slate proposal and its first reply together. Scene VII uses B79–85 as Babylon's final challenge, moves Revelation's summary B87–90 to the point at which all its distinctions have been heard, and retains B148–176 as the closing reply. Revelation keeps the last spoken word from the newer source. The added final silence marks an unresolved argument; it neither acquits Babylon nor declares Revelation defeated.

Substantive reprises retained

Purpose and culpability. A69–86, A134–155, A90–112, A158–175, B45–52. The axe establishes the distinction; the kings test it against Babylon's destruction; the final reprise asks whether employing guilty conduct is itself just.

The guilty questioner. A125–132 and B74–77. The earlier passage protects the right to question; the later passage admits Babylon's personal interest in the amnesty she proposes.

Healing and justification. A187–192, B28–43, B114–128, B169. Promise, objection, response, and final reminder remain distinct. No healing is silently turned into retrospective permission for harm.

Hearts and coercion. B21–26, B92–112, B170. Knowledge of motives, the demand for fidelity, and the measure of blame remain separate questions.

History and punishment. B54–77, B130–146, B148–176. The returned person's history is distinguished from what that history may authorize. The closing restatement is retained as a deliberate unresolved cadence.

No substantive repetition was deleted. The short final summary repeats earlier positions; it remains because it completes the newer document's dramatic reply.

Reference register

These are the references attached to the working text, moved out of the speeches. The links retain their original destinations. A reference supports the passage's textual anchor; it does not turn the whole imagined speech into a quotation or establish every philosophical inference. For exact-wording cautions, see Textual checks.

Scene I

1 Isaiah 47:1–15 [A22]

2 Revelation 18:3, 9–19 [A36]

3 Revelation 17:12–18 [A45]

4 Revelation 18:23, Greek text [A53]

5 Revelation 18:4–8, 21–24 [A64]

Scene II

6 Isaiah 47:6 [A75]

7 Isaiah 10:5–15 [A86]

8 Isaiah 10:5–15 [A145]

9 Isaiah 47:6–7 [A150]

10 Isaiah 10:24–27 [A155]

Scene III

11 Revelation 17:12–17 [A103]

12 Revelation 19:19–21 [A112]

13 Revelation 19:1–3 [A123]

14 Revelation 17:12–17 [A167]

15 Revelation 19:11–21 [A175]

16 Revelation 6:9–11 [A182]

17 Revelation 19:1–3 [A185]

18 Revelation 17:12–17 [B52]

Scene IV

19 Revelation 5:9–10; 14:9–11 [B5]

20 Revelation 13:15–17 [B12]

21 Revelation 14:9–12 [B19]

22 Revelation 2:23 [B26]

23 Revelation 2:23 [B97]

24 Revelation 2:8–11 [B107]

25 Revelation 14:6–12 [B112]

Scene V

26 Revelation 21:1–5 [A192]

27 Revelation 21:1–5 [B37]

28 Revelation 21:7–8 [B43]

29 Revelation 20:4; 19:1–2 [B119]

30 Revelation 16:4–7 [B126]

Scene VI

31 Revelation 20:12–15; OMNIBUS §10.3 [B63]

32 Revelation 20:12–15; 14:13 [B141]

Scene VII

33 Revelation 20:12–13 [B154]

Textual checks

Checked against the passages linked below on 17 October 2026. NRSVUE means New Revised Standard Version Updated Edition, hosted by Bible Gateway; NABRE means New American Bible Revised Edition, hosted by the USCCB. The sources mix translations. The dramatic wording has therefore not been silently standardized to a single Bible translation. Brief direct quotations are explicitly labeled. All other discussion in this section is editorial analysis.

Cruelty after delivery

Isaiah 47:1–15

Scriptural wording, NABRE, 47:6: “but you showed them no mercy”. The verse places delivery into Babylon’s power beside condemnation of her treatment of the aged. Verses 2–3 supply the exposure imagery; 7–10 address presumed permanence and confidence; 12–15 mock failed protection by sorcery and astrology. The imagined Isaiah’s concession that the imagery is violent is dramatic interpretation.

The axe and the conqueror

Isaiah 10:5–15 and 24–27

Scriptural wording, NRSVUE, 10:7: “But this is not what he intends”. Assyria is sent to plunder and trample in verse 6; its destructive intention and the king’s pride are distinguished in verses 7 and 12–15. The axe comparison is verse 15. Verses 24–27 promise release from the burden and yoke. A138 is an invented inference being rejected, not a biblical quotation. The distinction does not itself explain the morality of every means employed.

Merchants and sorcery

Revelation 18:3–24

Scriptural wording, NRSVUE, 18:13: “slaves—and human lives.” The merchants’ mourning is linked to lost purchasers in verse 11; verse 4 addresses God’s people within Babylon. Verses 23–24 place sorcery, deception, and bloodshed beside the city’s wealth and ending. The phrase about no new buyer inheriting her throne is the dramatization’s inference from the city’s finality, not an explicit constitutional claim in the chapter.

The Greek term

Revelation 18:23 Greek text

The displayed Greek includes φαρμακείᾳ, transliterated pharmakeia, with a spelling variant φαρμακίᾳ in some displayed editions. The sentence concerns the nations’ deception through Babylon’s sorcery. The verse does not specify a preparation, substance, or technique. The dialogue appropriately leaves the mechanism open; the word alone does not establish a modern technological or pharmaceutical claim.

The kings and the divine purpose

Revelation 17:12–18

Scriptural wording, NRSVUE, 17:17: “God has put it into their hearts to carry out his purpose”. The verse continues with agreement to give their kingdom to the beast until God’s words are fulfilled. Verse 16 describes destruction of the woman; verse 14 describes the kings’ war against the Lamb. The exact relation between the stated purpose and each violent act is the dramatic question. The text does not make their allegiance faithful.

Judgment of the destroyers

Revelation 19:1–3 and 11–21

Scriptural wording, NABRE, 19:11: “He judges and wages war in righteousness.” The chapter calls judgment true and just, associates Babylon’s condemnation with avenged blood, and depicts the beast and false prophet thrown into fire. It does not explicitly state that the beast is punished for destroying Babylon. The source afterword’s caution is retained in full below. “Its justice rests upon who God is” is a dramatic theological argument, not a quotation.

The murdered and their waiting

Revelation 6:9–11

The slain witnesses ask how long judgment and vengeance will wait. They receive robes and are told to wait while further fellow servants are to be killed. This supports the dramatic reminder that the demand for judgment comes from victims and that the waiting itself remains terrible; it does not settle the proportionality of the eventual punishment.

The Lamb and the captive

Revelation 5:9–10

The slain Lamb’s redemption of people from the nations anchors Babylon’s opening concession in Scene IV. The suffering before the Lamb belongs to Revelation 14:9–11, a separate linked passage. The conjunction in the speech is a philosophical demand to consider the two together, not a single biblical quotation.

Coercion and the warning

Revelation 13:15–17

The image can have non-worshipers put to death; the mark restricts buying and selling and reaches free and enslaved people. Babylon’s two kneeling people are imagined cases used to test that coercive setting. They are not separately narrated individuals in Revelation, and the text does not disclose their personal hearings.

Punishment and endurance

Revelation 14:9–13

Scriptural wording, NABRE, 14:10: “before the holy angels and before the Lamb”. The warning announces torment for worship or acceptance of the mark; it is followed by endurance and the faithful dead’s works accompanying them. It does not separately give a scale of culpability for different degrees of duress. Neither automatic acquittal under fear nor equal blame in every case should be presented as an explicit rule supplied here.

Hearts and fidelity

Revelation 2:8–11 and 23

Scriptural wording, NABRE, 2:23: “the searcher of hearts and minds”. The verse also speaks of recompense according to works, within the severe address to Thyatira. The call to fidelity until death is in the distinct address to Smyrna, 2:10. Knowledge of inward motives is textually asserted; a detailed account of how fear changes a sentence is not. The dramatic concession makes that limit visible.

The promise and its boundary

Revelation 21:1–8

Scriptural wording, NABRE, 21:4: “He will wipe every tear from their eyes”. The promise of an end to death and pain stands alongside the second death in verse 8. Babylon correctly refuses to turn the promise into an explicit universal embrace. Her distinction between arriving unharmed and arriving healed is philosophical analysis. No painless alternative is established merely by proposing one; neither is necessity established merely by the promised end.

Repayment for bloodshed

Revelation 16:4–7

The angel connects the blood to drink with blood shed by its recipients. Revelation’s speech therefore appeals to culpable injury as a ground for punishment, rather than solely to future happiness. Whether the measure and means are justified remains open to challenge in the drama. That ground cannot simply be borrowed to decide the captive’s case.

Return and continuing judgment

Revelation 20:4 and 12–15

Scriptural wording, NABRE, 20:13: “All the dead were judged according to their deeds.” Verse 4 supplies the vindication of martyred witnesses. Verses 12–15 connect the dead with their deeds and distinguish the book of life. They do not announce Babylon’s amnesty or require a new consent as a condition of judgment. Revelation’s argument that death must not end answerability is a philosophical defense placed in the character’s mouth, not a separately stated rationale in those verses.

The external clean slate rule

OMNIBUS v7.79-r1 §10.3

The linked document is titled OMNIBUS v7.79-r1 — Constitutional Foundation and Supported Repair. Its current §10.3, “Return Is Not Inheritance,” rejects automatic inherited guilt, punishment, obligation, and responsibility for prior conduct, and requires valid present consent for new obligations. It also says loop return does not establish identity continuity or moral progress. This is the author’s external normative framework, not biblical teaching. The linked document labels Section 10 a supported reconstruction, not a verbatim recovery. Babylon’s speech deliberately retains personal history while challenging continuing punitive liability; that dramatic formulation is not a verbatim reproduction of every OMNIBUS provision.

The notes identify textual support and limits. They do not settle the characters’ moral dispute or claim that a consistent rule is therefore a just one.

Source framing and afterword

The following non-dialogue passages are reproduced from Source A. They remain outside the performed cycle so that source commentary is not assigned to a character.

Opening frame A1

Yeah bro—imagined replies, with their arguments anchored to the texts. They get to challenge her defense, and the harsh parts of their own language stay visible.

Comment on the first Isaiah speech A22

This reply follows the chapter's accusations of cruelty, presumed permanence, misplaced confidence, and the failure of sorcery and astrology to avert judgment. Isaiah 47:1–15

Bridge A65

Yeah bro—Babylon has found the sentence she wants read twice.

Bridge A66

An imagined reply, with the textual anchors alongside it.

Concluding analysis A194

The textual limit matters here: Revelation does not explicitly say the beast is punished for destroying Babylon. It depicts the beast as God's enemy and ultimately judges it. These passages affirm that divine purpose, human guilt, and just judgment coexist; they do not fully explain why God employs these particular violent means. Babylon's moral challenge therefore remains a question the dramatization can press.

Other source furniture

A195 reads "5:51 PM". It is retained here as a source timestamp, not as a dramatic line or a verified time zone. Original standalone speaker labels have been regularized in the cycle; standalone dash paragraphs have become pauses or scene boundaries. Final empty paragraphs A196 and B177 are not reproduced as content.